

*An acorn woodpecker family may
store up to 50,000 acorns
in the same tree.*

Woodpecker



Knock, knock, knock! You'll often hear a woodpecker before you see it. A sign that an acorn woodpecker is near is a tree drilled with thousands of small, neat holes. Look carefully, and you'll spot acorns stuffed into many of them. In autumn, these woodpeckers collect masses of acorns from oak trees, then peck out a cubby-hole for each in their favourite tree to save for winter.

Most woodpeckers feed on wood-eating beetle grubs. To reach these tasty treats, the birds hammer the tree trunks with their pointed beak up to 15 times per second! Special muscles and sponge-like bone at the front of the skull protect their brain so that the birds are not knocked out by the force of their drilling.

